

wrong and that would damage your installation. So first things first — if the server is working the way you want it to, try not to change it (unless of course you are trying to learn more about Apache Web server itself).

Do remember that for developmental purposes, it is better to keep the security a little loose, while on the production server, it must be as tight as possible. If you are able to run multiple Web projects using just 'localhost', so much the better. If you have two projects named 'college' and 'personal', it is better to run them from <http://localhost/college> and <http://localhost/personal> when possible.

However, this is not always feasible and we might want separate domain names to test things out. To create a VirtualHost in Apache is not a very easy task if one has not done it previously. To make a new VirtualHost in Apache, follow the steps mentioned below (which have been tested with Apache installed with XAMPP; the configuration file governing the VirtualHosts might be different for other installations):

1. Open C:\xampp\apache\conf\extra\httpd-vhosts.conf file in a text-editor.
2. Add the following lines of code to the end (explained later):

```
<VirtualHost *:80>
    ServerAdmin youremail@host.com
    DocumentRoot "C:/xampp/v-htdocs/drupal.example.com"
    ServerName drupal.example.com
    ErrorLog "logs/drupal.example.com-error.log"
    CustomLog "logs/ drupal.example.com-access.log" common
</VirtualHost>
```

3. Save the file.
4. Open file: C:\Windows\System32\drivers\etc\hosts in Notepad and add this line at the end:
a. 127.0.0.1 drupal.example.com
5. Save the file and restart the Apache server. The lines you added in Step 2 play the following roles:
 - <VirtualHost *:80>: This starts the definition of the virtual host and says that it should be reachable from all addresses on port 80.
 - ServerAdmin: This is the email which is displayed in error messages and should be of the person who maintains the server.
 - DocumentRoot: The path of the folder from where the files of this VirtualHost will be served.
 - ServerName: The domain name to which this VirtualHost will respond.
 - ErrorLog: This is the path of the file where the error log should be stored. It is relative to the Apache installation directory.
 - CustomLog: Other error logs should be stored in the file indicated here.

- It is also important to make the changes in your hosts file later so that you can use the domain name of this virtual host on your machine.

MySQL

MySQL comes with XAMPP. If you are installing it outside of XAMPP, the wizard takes all the right steps. However, there are a few things to keep in mind:

1. The MySQL root password should not be forgotten.
2. The MySQL root password is set to blank by XAMPP, by default—this is not good for production servers.
3. You should try to have another user, even for developmental purposes because if you lose access to the root user, it would put you in trouble.

Though I have listed some important points, you will encounter other problems along the way. Remember that Google is a friend and the official forums are great when it comes to asking for help with each of those products. Happy coding! 

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